AMB Material Bot: Capabilities, Use Cases & Roadmap

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Summary

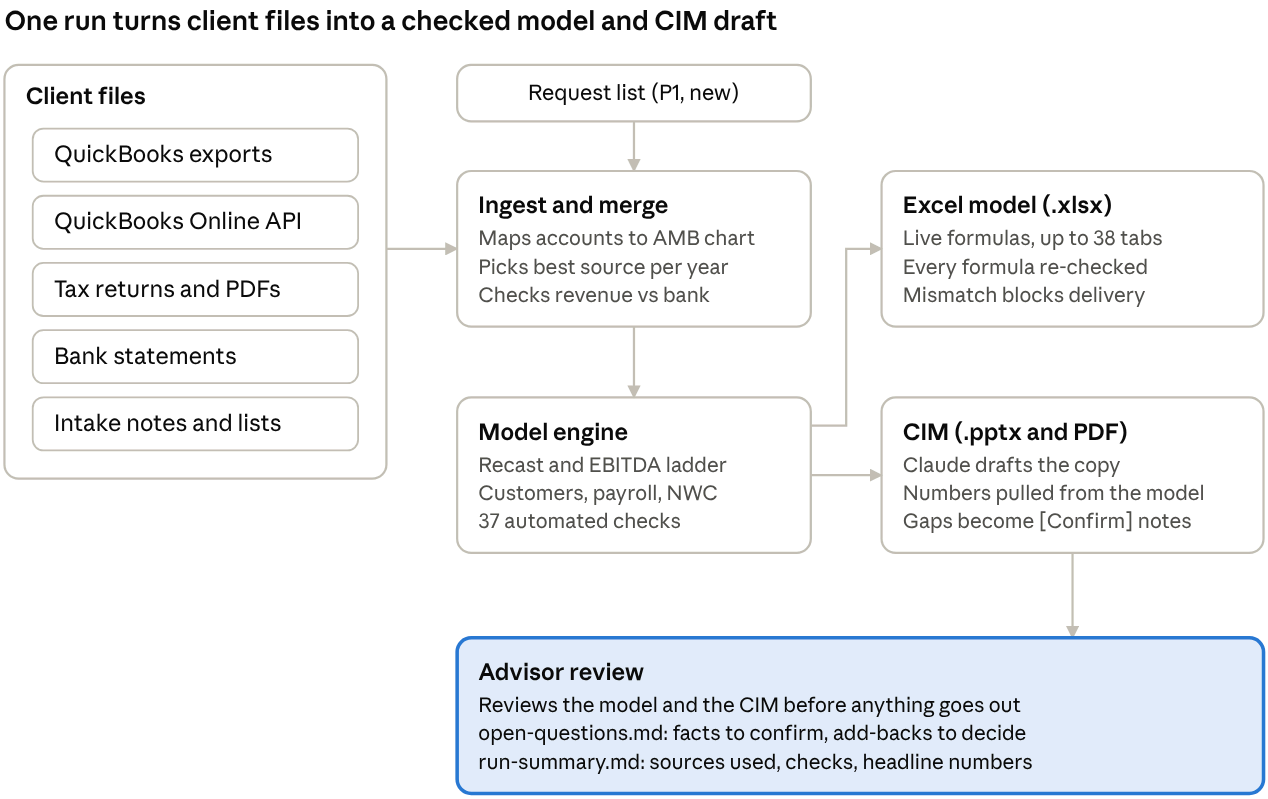
The AMB material bot turns a business's raw financial files into a first-draft sell-side package: a formula-driven financial model (.xlsx) and a CIM (.pptx and PDF), in AMB's house style, in under two minutes per deal. It reads QuickBooks, tax returns, bank statements and the seller's intake notes, recasts the numbers into Reported EBITDA, SDE and Adjusted EBITDA, and writes the deck from those same numbers.

It is built and tested but not yet proven on a live deal. The code lives in `grzepcasey-ui/PROJECT-AVENGERS` under `amb-material-bot/`. The build passed three rounds of independent review and all 362 automated tests on a fictional sample deal (Project Ridgeline, an HVAC business). The next step is a pilot on two or three real AMB deals.

Everything it produces is a draft for an advisor to review. Anything it cannot source becomes a `[Confirm: …]` placeholder and a line in `open-questions.md`, never an invented fact.

What it does, end to end

Each request on the list becomes a folder of draft deliverables ready for review in one run: the bot reads the client's files, builds the model, checks every formula, then writes the CIM from the model's numbers.



How one request becomes a draft package

When two sources cover the same year, the bot uses the one it trusts most and flags the differences. Likely add-backs, such as meals or vehicles, are proposed for review but never applied automatically. A bad row on the request list is reported without stopping the rest of the queue, and each row's status is updated to done, needs_info or error.

The financial model

The model is a live Excel workbook of up to 38 tabs, where every calculated cell is a formula and nothing is pasted as a value. On the sample deal it holds 11,567 formulas. Before delivery the bot recalculates every one of them independently and compares it with its own calculation. A single mismatch stops the workbook from being delivered.

Area	Tabs	What it gives the advisor
Front	Cover, Contents, Summary, Assumptions	One-page deal summary; every driver in one place

Area	Tabs	What it gives the advisor
Earnings	P&L Summary, Adj. EBITDA, Adjustments, Revenue Detail, Expense Detail	FY, YTD, LTM and pro forma columns; the ladder from Reported EBITDA to SDE to Adjusted EBITDA
Customers	Customer Overview, Customer Retention, Concentration, Cohorts	Coded customers (C-001…), top-10 share, gross and net dollar retention, cohorts
People	Headcount	Headcount by department, hires and departures, tenure, payroll tie-out
Balance sheet and cash	Balance Sheet, NWC, Debt-Like Items, Cash Flow, Proof of Cash	Working-capital peg, debt-like items, bank deposits reconciled to revenue
Forward look	Projections, Opportunities, Valuation, Deal Structure, Sensitivities	Driver-based projections, an internal valuation range, SBA debt coverage (DSCR)
Charts	Revenue, Expense, Headcount and Retention Charts	Monthly trends and seasonality
Data	Monthly P&L, Databook, Mapping, Raw tabs	Account-level source data, and how each account maps into the model

The adjustments logic follows AMB's house style.

- Every add-back is a numbered row on the Adjustments tab: [D] definitional, [N] normalization, [S] owner compensation, [PF] pro forma, [M] memo.
- Each row records its basis, source document, evidence grade and status.
- Only accepted rows enter the EBITDA ladder. Proposed rows, such as possible personal vehicle or fuel costs, wait in `open-questions.md` for an advisor's decision.
- The model switches to Main Street presentation, with SDE as the headline, when pro forma Adjusted EBITDA is under $1.0M. Above that it presents lower-middle-market style, led by Adjusted EBITDA.

37 automated checks run on every build:

- the balance sheet balances;

- the cash flow ties to balance-sheet cash;
- customer and payroll totals tie to the P&L;
- bank deposits cover reported revenue;
- the printed workbook has no cut-off or orphaned pages.

On the sample, 27 checks pass, 10 are not applicable (the sample lacks the data they need), and none fail.

Formatting follows the AMB model template: maroon headers, colour-coded inputs and links, yellow-boxed totals, a check row on every schedule, and print-ready pages.

The CIM

The CIM is an editable PowerPoint with native charts and tables, plus a PDF and page images. Its length depends on the deal: the Main Street target is 20 to 28 pages, and the sample came out at 21. The bot builds each section only when it has the data for it, and `run-summary.md` records why any section was left out.

Section	What it covers
Cover, disclaimer, contents	AMB-branded front matter under the deal's code name
Executive summary	Quick stats, transaction summary, investment considerations with page references, and considerations for buyers
Company overview	History, service lines, revenue mix, unit economics, facilities, fleet and systems
Customers	Customer mix, retention, concentration (customers coded C-001, not named)
Operations and people	Workforce by department, key employees, owner responsibilities and transition
Financial performance	Income statement, margins, cost ratios, monthly trends and seasonality
Adjusted EBITDA	Walk from Reported EBITDA to SDE to Adjusted EBITDA; each add-back graded by evidence
Balance sheet and cash flow	Working capital, debt-like items, free cash flow

Section	What it covers
Market	Built only when sourced market data is supplied
Transaction process, appendix	Process and next steps, definitions, twelve-month P&L

Design. The look was chosen from three competing design directions, each built to beat the reference CIMs Frank shared. Every page follows the same pattern:

- a headline that states a claim with a number;
- a titled exhibit;
- lettered observations keyed to rows in the exhibit;
- sources and footnotes, then the AMB footer.

The aim is a deck that reads as AMB's own, not as a generated template.

How the copy is written. With an API key, Claude drafts the text against a strict schema.

- **Numbers:** every figure in the copy is pulled from the model through a numbers brief, so the deck and the workbook cannot disagree.
- **Facts:** facts come only from the source files and intake notes. A missing fact becomes a red `[Confirm: …]` placeholder.
- **Style check:** before delivery, the text is checked against AMB's style rules, such as banned phrases, dash usage and word limits.

The CIM never shows a valuation or asking price, and without an API key the bot falls back to template text.

Use cases at AMB

The bot's main value is replacing the days of spreadsheet and slide assembly between receiving a client's files and having a draft to review.

Use case	How the bot helps	What the advisor still does
First-draft CIM and model on a new engagement	Builds both from the client's files in one run	Reviews, answers the `[Confirm]` list, edits the story

Use case	How the bot helps	What the advisor still does
Data-request tracking	`open-questions.md` lists every missing document, unsupported add-back and unconfirmed fact	Sends the list to the seller, re-runs when files arrive
Earnings recast and add-back review	Numbered adjustment schedule with basis, source and evidence grade; flags likely personal expenses without applying them	Accepts or rejects each proposed add-back
Quality-of-earnings style diligence prep	Proof of cash, bank deposits against revenue, customer and payroll tie-outs, working-capital peg	Judges the exceptions; commissions formal QoE where needed
Pricing and deal-structure conversations	Internal valuation range, SBA DSCR test, sensitivities (never shown in the CIM)	Sets the asking price and structure with the seller
Refreshing a live deal	Re-run as new months arrive to roll YTD, LTM and pro forma columns forward	Checks what moved
Consistency across the team	Every deal comes out in the same house style, vocabulary and check framework	Focuses review time on judgement, not formatting

It fits best on Main Street and lower-middle-market service businesses with QuickBooks books, which is the profile it was built and tested on.

How to run it

The bot runs from the command line on any machine with Node 20 or later and LibreOffice installed. LibreOffice is only needed for the PDF, the page images and the print check.

One-time setup

1. Clone `grzepcasey-ui/PROJECT-AVENGERS` and run `setup.bat` (Windows) or `setup.sh` (Mac), or `npm install` in `amb-material-bot/`.

2. Copy `.env.example` to `.env` and add an Anthropic API key and AMB's contact details.
3. Optional: connect QuickBooks Online by creating an Intuit developer app, then run `npm run bot -- qbo-connect` once per client.

Per deal

1. Add a row to `requests/live-requests.csv` with priority P1 and status `new`.
2. Put the client's files in `deals/<code-name>/`:
   - QuickBooks P&L and balance sheet exports (monthly preferred);
   - tax returns and bank statements;
   - intake notes;
   - optionally, add-back, customer and payroll lists.
3. Run `npm run bot -- run`.
4. Open `output/<request> <code name>/`. It holds the model, the CIM (.pptx and .pdf), `open-questions.md` and `run-summary.md`.
5. Review, then work through the open questions with the seller and re-run.

`npm run demo` builds the fictional sample deal without touching the request list. It is the fastest way to see what the bot produces.

Client files, outputs, the live request list and credentials are excluded from git. Files sent to Claude are processed under Anthropic's commercial API terms, which should be checked against AMB's engagement letters.

Limitations

The biggest limitation is that the bot has only been run on one fictional deal. Real client books are messier, so expect the first live deals to surface issues the tests did not.

Limitation	What it means in practice
Tested on one sample deal	Ridgeline is a clean, Main Street HVAC business. Lower-middle-market mode, odd fiscal years, multi-entity books and messy charts of accounts are covered by tests but unproven on real files.

Limitation	What it means in practice
Claude drafting not yet run live	The CIM text on the sample came from a reviewed fixture. The API path has never been run with a live API key, so the first live runs need a close read.
QuickBooks Online API untested live	It needs an Intuit developer app and a client authorisation per company. Exports are the proven route today.
PDF and tax-return reading depends on scan quality	Claude reads PDFs, so poor scans or unusual layouts need their numbers checked against the source.
Output is a first draft	Every run leaves `[Confirm]` placeholders (21 on the sample) and proposed add-backs that need an advisor's decision. Nothing should go to a buyer unreviewed.
No market section by default	The bot does no market research, so the Market section only appears when sourced market data is supplied.
Some pages are dense	A few CIM pages read like a databook. Six pages fall short of the 120-word commentary target, and some chart labels are untidy.
Workbook print polish	Some rows print with uneven gaps in the LibreOffice render (Excel may differ), and a few lookups use fixed row ranges the house style discourages.
Command-line only	There is no web interface. The request list is a CSV file, not Google Sheets or Notion.
Some checks need more data	Certain checks, such as the working-capital trend, need monthly balance sheets. Without them they show n.a. rather than pass or fail.

Room to grow

The first priority is proving the bot on real deals; most of the later items only matter once a pilot shows where it helps most.

Priority	Improvement	Why it matters
Now	Pilot on 2 to 3 closed AMB deals and compare the output with the materials the team built by hand	The only real test of accuracy and time saved
Now	First live runs with an API key, tuning the copy against Frank's reference CIMs	Confirms the drafting path and the AMB voice
Now	Close the three open polish items: row spacing, fixed-range lookups, thin commentary pages	Finishes the verification backlog
Next	Read deal folders from Google Drive and write outputs back to them	Removes the manual file shuffling
Next	Move the request list to Google Sheets or Notion	Lets the whole team queue and track requests
Next	Market section from sourced research, with citations	Fills the one section that is always missing today
Next	Lighten the densest CIM pages and add a one-page teaser	Better first impression for buyers
Later	More materials: buyer list, outreach emails, LOI comparison, QoE-style databook	Extends the bot across the deal process
Later	A web interface as the "Generate" button in the planned AMB Deal Platform	No command line for advisors
Later	Excel-native print check alongside LibreOffice	Closes the gap between the check and what clients see